

Word family: **ahead**

Base word: ahead

Part of speech: mainly **adverb**, sometimes functioning in fixed prepositional-style expressions such as **ahead of**

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **look ahead**

* **go ahead**

* **move ahead**

* **ahead of**

* **ahead of time**

* **ahead of schedule**

* **ahead of the competition**

* **get ahead**

* **stay ahead**

* **plan ahead**

* **straight ahead**

* **far ahead**

* **years ahead**

* **the road ahead**

* **ahead of your time**

Meaning in this passage

> **Looking ahead**, I honestly think he will grow into a very creative person.

Here, **ahead** is figurative.

look ahead = think about or consider the future — 展望未來；向前看

So:

Looking ahead = 展望未來；往後看

中文翻譯：

展望未來，我真的覺得他會成長為一個很有創意的人。

The speaker is not physically looking in front of them. They are mentally considering Leo's future.

1. **ahead** (在前面 ; 向前) — 在前方 ; 向前

This is the core spatial meaning.

Practice 1

> He walked a few steps **ahead** of us.

他走在我們**前面幾步**。

Practice 2

> I could see a bridge **ahead**.

我可以看見**前方**有一座橋。

MCQ-ready definition:

ahead = 在某人或某物前方的位置 ; 向前

2. **straight ahead** — 正前方 ; 一直向前

Practice 1

> Go **straight ahead** at the traffic lights.

到交通燈後**一直向前走**。

Practice 2

> The station is **straight ahead**.

車站就在**正前方**。

MCQ-ready definition:

straight ahead = 在正前方 , 或一直向前而不轉彎

3. **far ahead** — 遠在前方

Practice 1

> The other runners were already **far ahead**.

其他跑手已經**遠遠跑在前面**。

Practice 2

> We could see the town **far ahead**.

我們可以看到**遠處前方**的城鎮。

MCQ-ready definition:

far ahead = 在前方相當遠的位置

4. **ahead of someone/something (位置) — 在.....前面**

Practice 1

> She was walking **ahead of me**.

她走在我**前面**。

Practice 2

> A truck was driving **ahead of us**.

一輛貨車正行駛在我們**前方**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ahead of someone/something = 在某人或某物的前面位置

5. **ahead (較早 ; 提前) — 事先 ; 提前**

This moves from spatial “in front” to temporal “before.”

Practice 1

> It's a good idea to plan **ahead**.

提前規劃是個好主意。

Practice 2

> We booked the tickets several months **ahead**.

我們提前幾個月便訂了票。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****ahead = 比實際需要或事件發生時間更早****

6. ****plan ahead — 提前計劃****

Practice 1

> You need to ****plan ahead**** for a long trip.

長途旅行需要****提前計劃****。

Practice 2

> Good students often ****plan ahead**** before exams.

優秀學生通常會在考試前****提早規劃****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****plan ahead = 在事情發生之前預先安排和考慮****

7. ****ahead of time — 提前；提早****

Practice 1

> We arrived ****ahead of time****.

我們****提早****到了。

Practice 2

> Please submit the form ****ahead of time****.

請****提前****遞交表格。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****ahead of time = 比原定或需要的時間更早****

8. ****ahead of schedule — 比預定進度早；提前完成****

Practice 1

> The project is **ahead of schedule**.

這個項目的進度**比原定計劃快**。

Practice 2

> Construction finished two weeks **ahead of schedule**.

工程**比原定時間提前兩星期**完成。

MCQ-ready definition:

ahead of schedule = 比計劃中的進度或完成時間更早

9. **look ahead** — 展望未來；考慮未來

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> **Looking ahead**, I honestly think he will grow into a very creative person.

展望未來，我真的覺得他會成長為一個很有創意的人。

Practice 2

> We need to **look ahead** and think about what happens next.

我們需要**向前看 / 考慮未來**，想想下一步會怎樣。

Practice 3

> **Looking ahead**, the company plans to expand into new markets.

展望未來，公司計劃拓展新市場。

MCQ-ready definition:

look ahead = 思考、計劃或想像未來可能發生的事情

10. **the road ahead** — 未來的路；前路

Literal or figurative.

Practice 1

> The **road ahead** was narrow and steep.

前方的道路又窄又陡。

Practice 2

> The **road ahead** will not be easy.

未來的路不會容易。

MCQ-ready definition:

the road ahead = 字面指前方道路；引申指未來將要面對的發展或挑戰

11. **the years ahead / days ahead — 未來幾年 / 未來日子**

Practice 1

> There will be many challenges in the **years ahead**.

未來幾年會有很多挑戰。

Practice 2

> We have a lot to prepare for in the **days ahead**.

在**未來幾天**，我們有很多事情需要準備。

MCQ-ready definition:

the years/days ahead = 從現在開始往後的未來時間

12. **ahead of someone (排名 / 進度) — 領先某人**

Practice 1

> She is five points **ahead of** her closest rival.

她比最接近的對手**領先五分**。

Practice 2

> Our team is still **ahead**.

我們的隊伍仍然**領先**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ahead = 在比賽、排名或進度上處於較領先的位置

13. **ahead of the competition** — 領先競爭對手

Practice 1

> The company wants to stay **ahead of the competition**.

公司希望繼續**領先競爭對手**。

Practice 2

> Innovation helps businesses remain **ahead of their competitors**.

創新有助企業保持**競爭領先地位**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ahead of the competition = 在表現、創新或市場地位上比競爭對手領先

14. **get ahead** — 取得進展；出人頭地

Practice 1

> She works hard because she wants to **get ahead**.

她努力工作，因為她希望**取得成功 / 出人頭地**。

Practice 2

> Good communication skills can help you **get ahead** at work.

良好的溝通能力可以幫助你在工作上**取得進展**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****get ahead = 在事業、學習或人生中取得進步和成功****

15. ****get ahead of someone — 超越某人；取得領先****

Practice 1

> He trained hard to ****get ahead of the other runners****.

他努力訓練，希望****超越其他跑手****。

Practice 2

> The company is trying to ****get ahead of its competitors****.

公司正努力****超越競爭對手****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****get ahead of someone = 在表現、位置或進度上超越某人****

16. ****stay ahead — 保持領先****

Practice 1

> You have to keep learning to ****stay ahead****.

你必須不斷學習，才能****保持領先****。

Practice 2

> The team scored again to ****stay ahead****.

球隊再次得分以****保持領先****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stay ahead = 繼續保持比別人更領先的位置或水平****

17. ****ahead in work/study — 進度超前****

Practice 1

> I'm already **ahead** with my work.

我的工作進度已經**超前**。

Practice 2

> She's several chapters **ahead** of the rest of the class.

她的進度比班上其他同學**快了幾章**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ahead = 在工作、學習或計劃進度上比預期或其他人更快

18. **go ahead** — 繼續；開始做吧

A very common phrasal extension.

Practice 1

> "Can I ask a question?"

> "Sure, **go ahead**."

「我可以問一個問題嗎？」

「當然，**問吧 / 請說**。」

Practice 2

> We've decided to **go ahead** with the project.

我們已決定**繼續推行這個項目**。

MCQ-ready definition:

go ahead = 開始、繼續或獲准進行某件事

19. **go ahead** with something — 繼續進行某事

Practice 1

> They decided to **go ahead** with the plan.

他們決定**繼續執行計劃**。

Practice 2

> The event will **go ahead** despite the rain.

儘管下雨，活動仍會**照常進行**。

MCQ-ready definition:

go ahead with something = 不取消或停止，而繼續實行某項計劃

20. **move ahead** — 向前進；取得進展

Practice 1

> The line slowly **moved ahead**.

隊伍慢慢**向前移動**。

Practice 2

> We can now **move ahead** with the project.

我們現在可以**推進這個項目**。

MCQ-ready definition:

move ahead = 向前移動；引申為繼續發展或取得進展

21. **ahead of your time** — 思想 / 作品超越所處時代

Practice 1

> Her ideas were **ahead of their time**.

她的想法**超越了當時的時代**。

Practice 2

> The designer was years **ahead of his time**.

那位設計師的理念比當時**先進很多年**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ahead of your time = 思想、技術或作品比當代一般水平更先進

22. **think ahead** — 預先考慮；為未來打算

Practice 1

> You need to **think ahead** before making such a big decision.

作這麼大的決定前，你需要**預先考慮未來**。

Practice 2

> Good planners **think ahead**.

擅長規劃的人會**提前為未來作打算**。

MCQ-ready definition:

think ahead = 預先考慮未來可能出現的情況及需要

23. **ahead of the curve** — 領先趨勢；走在前端

A common figurative expression.

Practice 1

> The company tries to stay **ahead of the curve** in technology.

公司努力在科技方面**走在前端**。

Practice 2

> Her teaching methods were **ahead of the curve**.

她的教學方法**領先當時的趨勢**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ahead of the curve = 比一般趨勢或其他人更早採用、理解或掌握新的發展

24. **ahead of yourself** — 操之過急；想得太遠

Usually in:

get ahead of yourself

Practice 1

> Don't **get ahead of yourself**—we haven't won yet.

不要**想得太早 / 得意得太早**，我們還沒贏。

Practice 2

> I may be **getting ahead of myself**, but I'm already thinking about next year.

我可能**想得太超前了**，但我已經在想明年的事。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****get ahead of yourself = 在事情尚未發展到某一步前，就過早假設結果或計劃太後面的事情****

Important distinction 1: ****ahead vs in front****

Both can describe physical position.

****ahead****

usually focuses on direction or progress.

> She walked ****ahead of me****.

她走在我前面。

****in front of****

focuses more simply on location.

> She stood ****in front of me****.

她站在我前面。

For movement along a route, ****ahead**** is especially natural.

Important distinction 2: ****ahead vs forward****

ahead

often indicates the position/direction **in front** or a future point.

> Look **ahead**.

向前看。

forward

emphasizes motion toward the front.

> Move **forward**.

向前移動。

They overlap, but **ahead** more often describes where something is; **forward** often describes the direction of movement.

Important distinction 3: **look ahead vs look forward to**

Very important.

look ahead

= think about the future

> We need to **look ahead**.

我們要展望未來。

look forward to

= feel happy/excited about something in the future

> I **look forward to seeing you**.

我很期待見到你。

So:

look ahead ≠ look forward to

Important distinction 4: **ahead of time** vs **on time**

ahead of time

earlier than required.

> We arrived **ahead of time**.

我們提早到達。

on time

at the correct scheduled time.

> We arrived **on time**.

我們準時到達。

Important distinction 5: **ahead of schedule** vs **on schedule**

ahead of schedule

progress is faster than planned.

on schedule

progress is exactly as planned.

> The project is **ahead of schedule**.

項目進度超前。

> The project is **on schedule**.

項目按原定進度進行。

Important distinction 6: **ahead** vs **before**

before

general temporal ordering:

> I arrived **before** him.

我比他早到。

ahead of

can also express being earlier, but often implies an advantage, lead, or planned timing.

> We finished **ahead of schedule**.

我們比預定時間早完成。

So **ahead of** is not simply replaceable by **before** everywhere.

Important distinction 7: **get ahead** vs **move ahead**

get ahead

often = achieve personal/professional success.

> She wants to **get ahead** in her career.

她希望事業有成。

move ahead

often = continue/progress with a task or plan.

> Let's **move ahead** with the proposal.

我們繼續推進這個提議。

Important distinction 8: **go ahead** vs **go forward**

go ahead

often means:

* proceed

* begin

* give permission

> **Go ahead** and ask.

問吧。

go forward

more literally or formally means move/progress forward.

> The proposal will **go forward** for review.

提案將進入下一階段審議。

Important distinction 9: **ahead of someone vs better than someone**

ahead of someone

suggests a lead in:

- * position
- * score
- * progress
- * development

better than someone

directly evaluates quality or performance.

Someone can be **ahead** temporarily without necessarily being **better** overall.

Important distinction 10: **ahead of your time vs ahead in time**

ahead of your time

= unusually advanced for your era.

ahead in time

generally just means at a later point chronologically, though it is much less idiomatic as a standalone phrase.

So **ahead of your time** should be learned as a fixed expression.

Important distinction 11: **ahead as future metaphor**

A major conceptual pattern in English is:

future = physically in front of us

So English says:

* **look ahead** → consider the future

* **years ahead** → future years

* **road ahead** → future path

* **plan ahead** → plan for the future

That spatial metaphor is exactly what appears in your passage.

Family-extension note

Ahead has a very coherent semantic structure.

Its central image is:

in front

From that, English develops three major branches:

1. **physical position**

- * walk ahead
- * straight ahead
- * ahead of me

2. **time / future**

- * look ahead
- * plan ahead
- * ahead of time
- * years ahead

3. **progress / competition**

- * be ahead

- * get ahead
- * stay ahead
- * ahead of the competition

The semantic metaphor is highly systematic:

****physically in front****
 → ****earlier in time****
 → ****further progressed****
 → ****more advanced / leading****

So we should split these for learners, but keep their shared conceptual relationship clear.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
ahead	在前面；前方	physical position	
straight ahead	正前方；一直向前	direction	
far ahead	遠在前方	distant front position	
ahead of X	在 X 前面	position	
plan ahead	提前計劃	future preparation	
ahead of time	提前	earlier than necessary	
ahead of schedule	比預定進度快	faster than plan	
look ahead	展望未來	consider future	
road ahead	前路；未來	future path	
years ahead	未來幾年	future time	
be ahead	領先	competitive lead	
ahead of competitor	領先競爭者	comparative lead	
get ahead	取得成功 / 進展	advance	
stay ahead	保持領先	maintain lead	
move ahead	向前 / 推進	continue progressing	
go ahead	繼續；開始吧	proceed	
go ahead with X	繼續進行 X	execute plan	
ahead of your time	超越時代	unusually advanced	
think ahead	預先考慮	anticipate future	
ahead of the curve	領先趨勢	advanced relative to norm	
get ahead of yourself	操之過急；想得太早	move mentally too far ahead	

For your original sentence

> ****Looking ahead****, I honestly think he will grow into a very creative person.

Here:

look ahead = 展望未來；考慮將來

The speaker mentally moves from **Leo as he is now** to **Leo as he may become in the future**.

So the semantic path is:

ahead = physically in front

→ **future conceptualized as being in front of us**

→ **look ahead = think about the future**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> **展望未來**，我真的覺得他會成長為一個很有創意的人。

That future-oriented figurative sense is the key one for this passage.